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VNR VIGNANA JYOTHI INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY

(AUTONOMOUS)

B.Tech. III year I Semester Regular Examinations, January 2025

PROFESSIONAL ETHICS AND HUMAN VALUES

(Open Elective)

Time: 180 Minutes **Date of Examination: 03.Jan.2025** **Max. Marks: 60 Marks**

PART-A

I. Answer all the following: **5 × 2 Marks = 10 Marks**

1.	Define the Golden Rule in ethics and explain its significance.	CO-1	BL-2
2.	List the three types of ethical inquiry.	CO-2	BL-1
3.	Discuss the concept of "conscientiousness" in building a moral persona for a professional.	CO-3	BL-3
4.	List threats to moral autonomy at workplace.	CO-4	BL-1
5.	What is "Ethical Pluralism"? Justify how the Indian society is a good example of ethical pluralism.	CO-4	BL-1

PART-B

II. Answer one question from each unit. **5 × 10 Marks = 50 Marks**

UNIT-I

1.	Discuss the role of ethics in the context of legal frameworks. Provide examples where ethics serve as a basis for law.	CO-1	BL-2

(OR)

2.	Explain Maslow's Theory of Needs and how it can be applied to understand human values in the workplace.	CO-1, CO-5	BL-3

UNIT-II

3.	Analyse the ethical theory of deontological ethics. How does it differ from consequentialism?	CO-2	BL-2

(OR)

4.	Discuss Kohlberg's and Gilligan's theories of moral development. Do you think the difference in moral development among men and women also reflects in professional ethics of men and women at workplace? Justify with examples.	CO-2	BL-3

UNIT-III

5.	Discuss the responsibilities of STEM professionals as social experimenters in the context of ethics. Present suitable examples from various roles they may play.	CO-3	BL-2

(OR)

6.	Consider the scenario presented in Question 9 below. Considering the 3 C's of Business Ethics—Compliance, Contribution, and Consequences, how do these principles apply to the actions of OpenAI, the New York Times, and xAI? What ethical responsibilities do these organisations have towards each other, their employees, and the public? Do you think their actions are motivated by their own interests more than the sad demise of Suchir Balaji? Do you think business ethics apply differently to technology companies like OpenAI and xAI and to press/ media outfits like the the New York Times? Justify.	CO-4	BL-4

UNIT-IV

7.	Evaluate the ethical, social, and environmental implications of the Chernobyl disaster. What lessons can be learned from it?	CO-4	BL-3

(OR)

8.	Explain with examples the ethical challenges posed by emerging technologies like Generative AI, IoT, and Robotics.	CO-4	BL-3

UNIT-V

9.	Suchir Balaji, a former OpenAI Engineer, publicly revealed certain questionable practices of OpenAI, alleging that the company illegally used copyrighted data to train its AI models, and that their product, ChatGPT, was "actively damaging the Internet." The New York Times reported on Balaji's allegations and filed a lawsuit against OpenAI for using their copyrighted data without approval, naming Balaji as a witness. Elon Musk, who co-founded OpenAI and left in 2018, suspects foul play in Balaji's death. Musk's company, xAI, is also developing an AI agent named "Grok." Discuss the ethical considerations and challenges of whistleblowing in the context of the given scenario. How do you think one can achieve a balance between the duty to report unethical practices and the potential consequences for the whistleblower? How can organisations handle whistleblowers and protect their rights and use their information to improve themselves?	CO-5	BL-4
	(OR)		
10.	(a) Explain the ethical issues related to employee rights, loyalty, and trust within a corporate setting. (5 marks)	CO-5	BL-2
	(b) Briefly present ethical considerations for multinational companies. (5 marks)	CO-5	BL-2